



macOS Sierra 10.12.1 Beta

Apple macOS Sierra 10.12.1 Beta 5 is being seeded to developers and public testers. What are you waiting for? <http://dgit.in/SierraBeta>



New 'managed' Google Cloud

Google's Cloud Platform's storage is undergoing major changes in order to deliver and store data efficiently. <http://dgit.in/GglCldStr>

Bazaar

Sony MDR-1000X

More than just stellar audio

Sony's present generation flagship headphones, the MDR-1000X is meant to inherit the best of the previous flagship, the MDR-100ABN, while adding more features to it. In the core audio performance, the MDR-1000X presents more enthusiasm in the audio performance compared to the 100ABN.

The lows (bass) sound warm, rich, wholesome and mature, while maintaining clarity. There is plenty of emphasis put into the lows, which allows intricate bass notes to flourish in songs like Hump De Bump by The Red Hot Chili Peppers and the Foxy Lady Live at G3 Tokyo, 2005. The warmth of the bass adds a rich, plush tone to the audio, which sets up the premise for the great audio experience that we expected of the MDR-1000X. The lows are also very well-poised, and the overall composure of the low frequency performance means you'll hardly ever point out a loose end.

The mids are nicely detailed, continuing with the neatly composed bass delivery, but could have done with a bit more emphasis here. There is good clarity, and even the upper mids are well balanced, which you will distinctly get to hear in tracks like Luke Holland's cover of Skrillex's Cinema. Vocals sound prominent, clear and distinct, and the emphasis on the low frequencies do not overpower the vocals. In fact, this forms a good combination of warmth, clarity and rich tone to deliver tight, neatly laid out audio.

The highs are precise and smooth. They do not pierce, an optimisation that certainly helps when you are listening at very high volumes. For instance, drum cymbals are not piercing. Instead, they have a distinct, emphatic impact, which highlights the level of detail that the MDR-1000X is capable of producing. All of this sets up an excellent premise for elaborate soundstaging, but the MDR-1000X sounds more closed than wide. This can often become an issue for many, and tracks sound rather disconcertingly concentrated at times.

All of this combines to make the Sony MDR-1000X a more mature pair of flagship



Price
₹30,990

headphones, and is certainly a notable improvement over the MDR-100ABN, which sound rather loose in comparison. Moving on to the new features here, the Sony MDR-1000X presents improved noise cancellation with integrated machine learning that reportedly helps the headphone to learn your regular surroundings to provide better noise cancellation. We could not exactly determine the impact of this after about two weeks of listening on the MDR-1000X, as the noise cancellation in itself is now more powerful and enclosing.

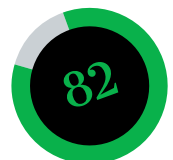
The Sony MDR-1000X also comes with two ambient sound modes - Normal and Voice. Switching to the Normal mode relays the environmental noise picked up by the two noise-receiving mics on the exterior of the headphones. In voice mode, while the rustle of leaves and footsteps nearby are more or less kept out, you will distinctly hear the voice of anyone talking near you. However, all of this does have a mechanical tone to it, and you will feel as if you are getting to hear all the noise around you through some filter.

The Quick Listen mode is also quite useful, where raising your hands to the upper edge of the earcups temporarily overrides the music and switch on the Voice mode. Volume and track controls are placed as touch gestures on the right earcup, and take some getting used to.

In terms of battery life, the Sony MDR-1000X delivers less than the Sony MDR-100ABN. It takes about an hour or more to fully charge, and available playback time with Noise Cancellation switched on is about 4 hours and 33 minutes. This could have been increased, although Sony does include a 3.5mm analogue connector if you run out of charge on the go.

To sum up, the Sony MDR-1000X is one of the best, premium noise cancelling pair of headphones in India right now. It is rather expensive, but offers great audio quality and smart noise cancelling features on it, making it a worthy pair of headphones to own.

Souvik Das



Features.....	88
Design.....	80
Performance.....	94
Value.....	57

Specifications

Headphone type: Closed, Dynamic, Circumaural, **Driver:** 40mm, Dome Type (CCAW Voice Coil), **Frequency Response:** 4Hz-40000Hz, **Microphone:** Electret Condenser, Unidirectional, 100Hz-8000Hz, **Diaphragm:** Aluminium-coated Liquid Crystal Polymer, **Weight:** 275 grams

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